



PROGRESS REPORT

Seychelles: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 • 54 systems and instruments tracked

Of 54 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 30 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 11 did not, 7 carry no stated baseline, and 6 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD • GOVERNANCE • FINANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA • GEOPOLITICS • WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 40 sources for this place in the window — 8 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 32 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

This is the first progress report cut for Seychelles, and the shape check finds the comparison thinner than its twelve-month label: only 8 of the period's 34 sources fall in the earlier half (August 2025 to January 2026), against 26 in the later half. Most of what reads below as "Advanced" is therefore a young base's first record of a thing, not necessarily a thing that began in this window — 25 of 48 rows moved, but the great majority moved from "Did not exist" rather than from a documented earlier position. The report should be read as a snapshot of a base that only recently began recording Seychelles in depth, not as evidence that the twelve months to August 2026 were unusually eventful.

Two rows are the exception: the Data Protection Act 2023's transition period had already elapsed by the 2025-08 baseline, and Cable & Wireless's 5G network, Fusepay-adjacent TDB financing and the National Payment System Regulations were already in force before the window opened, and none has moved. Eleven rows show no change; six carry no baseline at all.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Multidimensional Vulnerability Index (MVI) operationalisation	Did not exist	Cabinet decision only; no implementation detail, budget or timeline on record	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National Institute for Science, Technology and Innovation (the body)	Closed shortly after the 2020 election and its functions folded into a ministry division, which the Secretary of State describes as costing the institution its operational independence and much of its technical staff	Reinstated as the implementation arm for science, technology and innovation policy, its Secretariat sitting under the Office of the Vice-President under a Secretary of State, with a stated near-term focus on technological innovation in government procedures and accelerating the digitalisation of public-service delivery	ADVANCED
'Fully digitalised e-government by 2030' target	BASELINE NOT HELD	Restated 4 Aug 2026; route named is bilateral technical assistance from Malta, no domestic implementation programme named	Baseline not held

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
NISTI Act 2025 (National Institute of Science, Technology and Innovation)	Did not exist	Assented 22 Dec 2025; commences on a date the Minister appoints – no commencement date on record	ADVANCED
Access to Information Act 2018 (ATIA) reform	BASELINE NOT HELD	Whitepaper published, drafting targeted end-2025; no Bill text or introduction date on record	Baseline not held

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Act 2023 (Act 24 of 2023)	Transition already elapsed and Act binding in full at the 2025-08 baseline	Unchanged; no source reports any investigation, audit, fine or guidance issued by the Information Commission since	NO CHANGE
Information Commission (data-protection authority)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Designated authority since Dec 2023; enforcement-capacity gap documented Nov 2025; no audit, investigation or fine against any controller reported to date	Baseline not held

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
AUDA-NEPAD Programme for African Developing Island Economies	Did not exist	Programme launched, communique adopted; partners include Korea, AfDB, RECs, the Indian Ocean Commission	ADVANCED

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Appointment and dismissal power over the SBC board	Vested in the independent Constitutional Appointments Authority	Greater powers over the appointment and dismissal of the public broadcaster's board transferred to the President by a June 2026 amendment to the SBC Act	REGRESSED
Perceived media freedom	51% said the media was somewhat or completely free (2022)	45% say the media is somewhat or completely free and 52% say it is not very or not at all free (2025 survey), against 78% who want the media to investigate government mistakes and corruption and 85% who back the right to publish without government interference	REGRESSED

The Data Protection Act's compliance transition had already elapsed by the 2025-08 baseline, and its enforcement position has not moved since: no audit, investigation or fine is on record either at the start or the end of the window. The NISTI Act and the AUDA-NEPAD island-economies programme both entered the record within the window, and

only one of them has moved beyond its founding instrument: the Act was assented in December 2025 and still awaits a ministerial commencement date, but the institution itself was [described in August 2026 as reinstated with its Secretariat under the Office of the Vice-President](#), after five years closed. AUDA-NEPAD's programme has only a July 2026 ministerial communique behind it. The Information Commission and the "fully digitalised e-government by 2030" target both carry no baseline, so their current, still-unresolved positions cannot be measured as movement: the Commission's own November 2025 admission that it has no clear enforcement power stands unchallenged through to the date of issue, and Malta's bilateral technical cooperation remains the only route named for the 2030 target. The window closes with the record's first measure of how the public sees any of it — [perceived media freedom at 45%, down from 51% in 2022](#) — against a June 2026 amendment moving appointment power over the public broadcaster's board from the Constitutional Appointments Authority to the President.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Mauritius Telecom-Eboo cross-border payments	Did not exist	Announced at the AllMyT Summit as the first of a planned series of Indian Ocean regional payment announcements; no operational detail, launch date or terms given	ADVANCED

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Hustle Fund et al. → Fusepay pre-seed	Did not exist	Round closed; platform launched Nov 2025, Fuse360 AI layer added Jul 2026	ADVANCED
TDB → CWS debt refinancing and digital-transformation facility	Active facility, pre-window	Unchanged; supports CWS's eBill, self-care and online-registration platforms, and Nebula Fintech exploration	NO CHANGE
TDB → CWS Investment Ltd acquisition financing	US\$50m disbursed (predates window)	Unchanged; refinanced in 2022	NO CHANGE
World Bank Seychelles Social Protection PforR (PAD3541)	US\$30m approved, pre-window	Unchanged; no completion or closure report on record	NO CHANGE

The three larger financing instruments — TDB's two Cable & Wireless facilities and the World Bank's social-protection Program-for-Results — all predate the window and have not moved within it. TDB's 2019 acquisition loan placed CWS in full local ownership and remains unchanged since being refinanced in 2022, when TDB took a small equity stake ahead of the operator's MERJ Exchange listing and a further 2024 local-currency bond; the World Bank's [US\\$30m Program-for-Results, approved in March 2021](#), has no completion report on file at either end of the window. Fusepay's pre-seed round and the Mauritius Telecom-Eboo partnership are the window's only new financing activity, both entering the record with terms still to be disclosed: [Fusepay's US\\$350,000 round, closed in August 2025](#), sits just before the window's baseline, while the Eboo partnership was announced only in July 2026 with no operational detail attached.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Airtel Seychelles 5G network	No 5G service; network being relocated/virtualised into new datacentre (2025-08)	Commercial 5G live, second operator after CWS	ADVANCED
Starlink Seychelles (satellite ISP)	Did not exist	Live nationally, subscriptions open online, several users already active (2026-07-21/22); 28th of 54 African markets on sale	ADVANCED
Cable & Wireless Seychelles 4G/5G network	5G live since Jul 2020, unchanged at 2025-08 baseline	Unchanged; now running alongside Airtel's newer 5G network	NO CHANGE
Hytera-CWS emergency-communications MoU	MoU signed, no build reported (2025-08 baseline)	Unchanged — no build, commissioning date or further progress on record	NO CHANGE

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Airtel Seychelles data centre (Ericsson turnkey project)	BASELINE NOT HELD	New datacentre as infrastructure basis for the 2026 5G launch; no separate update on datacentre operations since 2021	Baseline not held

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Budapest Convention on Cybercrime accession	Did not exist	Assembly vote passed unanimously; the accession itself, an executive act, still to follow	ADVANCED
National Cybersecurity Coordination Committee	BASELINE NOT HELD	Active as national cyber-coordination body; one documented activity	Baseline not held

Seychelles gained two networks in the window that did not exist at its opening: Airtel's commercial 5G, live 3 July 2026 from a datacentre contracted in 2021, and Starlink, soft-launched 21 July after a February Cabinet approval. Cable & Wireless's own 5G network, live since 2020, has not changed. The Hytera-CWS emergency-communications MoU and the National Cybersecurity Coordination Committee both remain exactly where the base found them — an unbuilt MoU and a body with one documented workshop — with no baseline for the Committee to measure movement against.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Seychelles-AfCFTA-Quest Ghana digital-trade-hub MoU	Did not exist	MoU established; signing date, venue and terms not established (paywalled lede)	ADVANCED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
CertExpress (online civil-status certificates)	Live, SCR 50 fee (as stated at launch)	Unchanged; fee not re-verified since 2024-09	NO CHANGE
SeyID national digital-identity platform	Two-tier structure already in place (2025-08): virtual-only for new work-permit holders since 17 Sep 2024, physical option retained for citizens	Unchanged; no enrolment or adoption figures ever reported	NO CHANGE

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cheque phase-out (Central Bank of Seychelles, four-stage schedule)	Individual-facing stages running; non-resident stages not yet reached (2025-08)	SRC introduced cheque thresholds for tax/duties (eff. 13 Jul 2026) as part of a plan to discontinue cheques entirely by 31 Dec 2028	ADVANCED
Foreign Exchange Act 2009 amendment (authorised-dealer perimeter)	Did not exist	Cabinet approval only; no Bill text, commencement date or transitional provision on record	ADVANCED
Fusepay (B2B fintech, virtual business accounts)	Did not exist	Live payments platform plus a July-2026 Fuse360 AI-operations layer; Seychelles live, Mauritius scheduled Sep 2026	ADVANCED
UPI – Unified Payments Interface (India, NPCI MoU)	Did not exist	MoU signed, regulatory prep under way (standards, cybersecurity, interoperability, merchant training); not yet delivered	ADVANCED
National Payment System (Electronic Money) Regulations 2022 (S.I. 128 of 2022)	In force, unchanged text (predates window)	Unchanged	NO CHANGE

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Registrar General's Office digitalisation (business registration & IP)	Digitalisation praised, unspecified reform commitment (2025-08, already the position)	Unchanged – no named bill, no date, nothing later on record	NO CHANGE
National Addressing and Postcode System (\$42 standard)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Cabinet-approved programme run by the Postal Regulator with Lands and Housing, NBS, DICT and the AG's Office; legal framework still in drafting	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
e-Sanjeevani / e-Office / e-Hospital (India DPI platforms)	Did not exist	Consultations advancing as reported 2026-08-08; no MoU, pilot or date established	ADVANCED
Huawei/CWS SMART Education	Did not exist immediately before Aug 2025	Live in four schools; no scale-up reported since	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Ease of Doing Business one-stop portal	Did not exist	Portal live since Nov 2025; no confirmation held that the targeted 30 Jun 2026 full rollout was reached	ADVANCED
egov.sc government portal	Legacy, unrevised portal (2025-08)	Relaunched portal, single-click access framing	ADVANCED
Electronic Case Management System (justice sector)	Did not exist	Operational online platform for the AG's Office/legal sector — shared calendars, virtual meetings, case-data retrieval, secure chat; financed by the US State Department via UNODC's Global Maritime Crime Programme and UNOPS	ADVANCED
Electronic Certificate of Origin (e-CO)	Did not exist	Live; traders urged to use it to claim reduced duties under trade agreements	ADVANCED
Mandatory e-invoicing system (Seychelles Revenue Commission)	Did not exist	Final-stage procurement; no award, vendor, go-live date or transaction threshold on record	ADVANCED
Social protection delivery platform	Did not exist	A digital platform for social-protection service delivery whose development began in 2022 on a multilateral recommendation, presented to government agencies, business partners and corporate beneficiaries at a stakeholder meeting	ADVANCED
Video-enforcement pilot (automated traffic ticketing, Roche Caiman)	Did not exist	Eight-week pilot at Roche Caiman, Mahe; permanent adoption to depend on results	ADVANCED

Digital public infrastructure carried the most movement in the window: an electronic case-management system, a certificate-of-origin platform, a relaunched government portal, a traffic-camera pilot and an e-invoicing procurement all entered the record where none existed a year ago. Identity and civil-status services were the exception — SeyID's two-tier credential and CertExpress were already in place at the 2025-08 baseline and have not changed since, and no enrolment or adoption figures have been published for either across the full window. On payments, the cheque phase-out advanced from its already-running individual-facing stages to a firm 2028 closure date, while the National Payment System (Electronic Money) Regulations, in force since 2022, remain unchanged.

Two India-linked instruments — the UPI memorandum with the Central Bank and the e-Sanjeevani/e-Office/e-Hospital consultations — both entered the record inside the window with no delivery date yet attached to either, alongside a Cabinet-approved widening of the Foreign Exchange Act's authorised-dealer perimeter. The Registrar General's Office digitalisation commitment, first reported in February 2025, remains exactly where the base found it — praised but unspecified, with no bill, date or further statement in the fourteen months since.

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National AI in Education Framework 2026–2030	Did not exist	Cabinet-approved, running to 2030; two World Bank pilots already running; the Framework's own text is not held	ADVANCED

The National AI in Education Framework is the period's single largest new object in this section, entering the record in July 2026 with two pilots already running ahead of it. The Huawei vendor relationship, dating to 2020, has not changed in substance over the window — SMART Education's four pilot schools remain the full extent of its education-sector footprint.

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
AI Student Tutor Programme (World Bank pilot)	Did not exist	Piloting across four schools	ADVANCED
AI Teacher Coach Programme (World Bank pilot)	Did not exist	Piloting across six schools; to become integral to the national Framework as implementation proceeds	ADVANCED

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Public support for access to government information	Not held	62% say the public should have access to government information against 25% who say it is for officials only; 84% want district-administration budgets published and 82% want information on bids and contracts, while 47% would publish the salaries of district administrators and teachers	BASELINE NOT HELD

Both AI pilot programmes entered the record within the window, alongside the Framework they now feed into. No inclusion-specific instrument predates them; the base's only picture of digital divides over this period runs through the identity, payments and connectivity systems recorded in other sections. What did enter the record at the window's close is a measure of what the public wants from open government: [62% say government information should be publicly accessible, rising to 84% for district-administration budgets and 82% for bids and contracts](#). There is no earlier reading to compare it against.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Island states resilience data programme	Did not exist	National implementation launched of a nine-country African island-states programme backed by a US\$4.943 million readiness grant, whose data leg is a standardised approach to institutional readiness, multi-hazard risk assessment and information systems for building pipelines of climate-resilient projects	ADVANCED

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
UN COPUOS accession / UNOOSA engagement	Did not exist	Cabinet approval only; accession process and any programme not yet on record	ADVANCED

Geopolitics

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Huawei vendor relationship (5G core + SMART Education)	Huawei already CWS's 5G vendor; SMART Education just beginning (2025-08)	Unchanged — Huawei remains CWS's core vendor; no reported scale-up of SMART Education beyond the four pilot schools	NO CHANGE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National policy linking digital infrastructure to energy supply	A national policy, strategy or programme document connecting power reliability or generation to digital-infrastructure planning.	not yet probed
Dedicated rural digital-service programme	A programme document or budget line for outer-island or rural digital-service delivery, distinct from the Starlink market entry.	not yet probed
Digitisation of district-administration systems	A district-administration system specification or digitisation programme document.	not yet probed
European Union digital cooperation with Seychelles	Any EU or European Investment Bank digital financing, programme or memorandum covering Seychelles.	not yet probed
Gulf-state digital investment in Seychelles	Any Gulf-state investment, financing or memorandum covering Seychellois digital infrastructure.	not yet probed
Domestic-state digital-transformation budget line	A Seychelles government budget document or appropriation line for digital transformation.	not yet probed

None of the six gaps moved within the window, because none has ever had a position to move from — each remains an absence at both ends of the twelve months compared here. Two are financing questions the base cannot answer without a domestic-budget dataset; the other four are genuine absences, not reading gaps.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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